

THE PALADIN

CLASS HANDBOOK



The Holy Knight!

Welcome, brave hero! As a Paladin, you are a shining beacon of hope and justice. You wear the heaviest armor, wield mighty weapons, and use holy magic to protect your friends and defeat evil monsters. You have sworn a sacred oath to do what is right!



AWESOME PALADIN POWERS

DIVINE SMITE

This is your coolest move! When you hit a monster with your weapon, you can use a spell slot to make your weapon explode with radiant holy light. It does massive extra damage, especially against undead monsters like zombies and vampires!

LAY ON HANDS

You have a pool of magical healing power. As an action, you can touch a wounded friend and instantly heal them! You can also use this power to cure diseases and poisons.

REACTION (WHEN IT'S NOT YOUR TURN)

- **Opportunity Attack:** If a monster tries to run away from you, you can swing your sword at them for free!
- **Protection Fighting Style:** If a monster attacks a friend standing next to you, use your shield to block the attack!

DON'T FORGET: DIVINE SMITE!

When you hit a monster with a regular attack, you can decide *right then* to use a spell slot and add massive **Divine Smite** damage! You don't even need an action for it.

DRAW YOUR HERO!

What does your mighty Paladin look like? What kind of armor do they wear? Do they have a cool cape or a giant glowing sword? Draw them in the box below!

- **What is their name?**

- **What is their favorite food?**

- **What is the color of their magic?**

AURA OF PROTECTION

As you level up, you start glowing with an invisible shield of good energy. Any friend standing near you gets a bonus to their saving throws. You make everyone around you braver and safer!

STRENGTHS AND WEAKNESSES

- **Strengths:** You are super tough! With heavy armor and high health, it's hard for monsters to take you down. You can also deal huge bursts of damage with Divine Smite and heal your friends when they are in trouble.
- **Weaknesses:** You aren't very sneaky because of your clunky armor. Also, you don't have many ranged attacks, so you need to run right up to monsters to hit them!

LEVELING UP (LEVELS 1-5)

As you adventure and defeat monsters, you will gain experience points and level up! Here is what you get at the first 5 levels:

LEVEL	NEW POWERS!
Level 1	Divine Sense: You can magically sense if there are angels, demons, or undead nearby. Lay on Hands: You get your magical healing touch!
Level 2	Fighting Style: You become an expert at fighting with a shield, a big sword, or protecting your friends. Spellcasting: You learn to cast holy spells! Divine Smite: You can now make your weapon glow and do extra damage!
Level 3	Divine Health: You are immune to all diseases. You can never get sick! Sacred Oath: You choose the special promise you make as a Paladin (your Subclass).
Level 4	Ability Score Improvement: You can make your Strength or Charisma even higher, making you stronger or more magical!
Level 5	Extra Attack: You are so fast you can now attack twice in one turn! 2nd-Level Spells: You learn more powerful holy spells, like <i>Find Steed</i> to get a magic horse!

SUBCLASSES: YOUR SACRED OATH

At Level 3, you choose a Sacred Oath. This is a promise you make to be a hero, and it gives you special powers! Here are two fun options:

- **Shield of Missile Attraction:** This shield magically pulls enemy arrows toward it so they hit the shield instead of your squishy friends!
- **Winged Boots:** Since Paladins are usually slow in heavy armor, these magic boots let you fly! You can zoom into the air to fight flying dragons.
- **Amulet of Health:** This shiny necklace makes you immune to getting sick or poisoned, keeping you strong on long adventures.

COMBAT CHEAT SHEET

Not sure what to do on your turn? Here is a quick guide to your Paladin moves!

ACTION (CHOOSE ONE)

- **Attack:** Swing your sword! (At Level 5, you get to swing twice!)
- **Lay on Hands:** Touch a hurt friend to heal them instantly.
- **Cast a Spell:** Use a spell like *Cure Wounds* or *Bless*.

BONUS ACTION (CHOOSE ONE)

- **Smite Spell:** Cast a spell like *Thunderous Smite* to make your next weapon attack extra explosive!
- **Vow of Enmity:** Some Oaths let you use your Bonus Action to lock onto a boss monster and get Advantage against them!

SIR GALAHAD THE PURE

A knight of King Arthur's Round Table, known for his shiny white armor and perfect manners. He found the legendary Holy Grail because his heart was so good!

LADY KIMA OF VASSELHEIM

A fierce and strong halfling Paladin who isn't afraid to stand up to giant dragons. She proves that true bravery comes in all sizes!

BAHAMUT'S CHAMPIONS

Many Dragonborn Paladins swear their oath to Bahamut, the Platinum Dragon. They travel the world stopping evil dragons and protecting towns from fiery danger.

BEST MAGIC ITEMS

Every knight needs legendary gear! Keep an eye out for these awesome magical treasures:

- **Holy Avenger:** The ultimate Paladin sword! It glows with bright light and does massive damage to evil monsters. It even protects you and your friends from enemy magic!

OATH OF DEVOTION (THE CLASSIC HERO)

You are the ultimate knight in shining armor! You promise to always be honest, brave, and kind. You protect the weak and fight against evil.

- **Sacred Weapon:** You can make your weapon glow with bright light, making it easier to hit monsters.
- **Turn the Unholy:** You can hold up your holy symbol and scare away zombies, skeletons, and demons!

OATH OF THE ANCIENTS (THE NATURE KNIGHT)

You love the beauty of the world! You protect forests, animals, and joy. You are like a fairy-tale knight who uses nature magic.

- **Nature's Wrath:** You can summon magical vines from the ground to trap monsters so they can't move!
- **Turn the Faithless:** You can scare away evil fairies and demons with the power of nature.

GEAR & STRATEGY

WEAPONS & ARMOR

Paladins need the best gear to survive!

- **Armor:** Wear the heaviest armor you can find, like Chain Mail or Plate Armor. It makes you very hard to hit!
- **Sword and Shield:** A great choice! A longsword in one hand and a shield in the other makes you super tough.
- **Greatsword or Halberd:** If you want to do the most damage, use a giant two-handed weapon!

HOW TO FIGHT

You are the frontline defender! Run right up to the biggest, scariest monster and keep its attention so it doesn't attack your squishier friends like Wizards or Bards. Save your **Divine Smite** for when you really need to do a lot of damage, especially if you roll a Critical Hit (a Natural 20), because the smite damage doubles too!

ROLEPLAYING YOUR PALADIN

BACKGROUND IDEAS

Who were you before you became a Paladin?

- **The Squire:** You used to carry the shield for an older knight, and now it's your turn to be the hero!
- **The Farm Kid:** You found a glowing magic sword in a field and realized you were chosen to save the world.
- **The Royal Guard:** You were trained in a castle to protect the king and queen, but now you want to help everyone.

HOW TO ACT

You are a hero of justice! Think about what your **Sacred Oath** is. Did you promise to protect the innocent? Or did you promise to hunt down evil dragons? Speak with confidence, stand up for people who can't defend themselves, and always try to do the right thing. You are a natural leader! Don't be afraid to give inspiring speeches to your friends when things look scary.

LEVELING UP (LEVELS 6-10)

You are getting even stronger! Here are the amazing new powers you unlock as you reach level 10:

LEVEL	NEW POWERS!
Level 6	Aura of Protection: You glow with magical safety! You and friends standing near you get a big bonus to resist bad magic and dragon breath!
Level 7	Sacred Oath Feature: You get a special new power depending on the Oath you chose at Level 3.
Level 8	Ability Score Improvement: Make your Strength or Charisma even higher!
Level 9	3rd-Level Spells: You learn even stronger magic, like <i>Revivify</i> to bring a friend back to life or <i>Blinding Smite</i> to blind your enemies!
Level 10	Aura of Courage: You and your friends standing near you can never be frightened. You are totally fearless!

FAMOUS HEROES & LEGENDS

Throughout history, many brave Paladins have protected the innocent. Here are a few famous ones you can look up to: